

2022

2007

2005

► Maruti Suzuki in May announces an investment of ₹11,000 crore for phase 1 of its 800-acre new manufacturing plant (annual capacity of 1 million cars) in Haryana. At present, MSIL has a cumulative production capacity of about 2.2 million units per annum



► This year, Maruti Udyog changes its name to Maruti Suzuki India Ltd (MSIL), where 'Maruti' represents a strong domestic brand while 'Suzuki' adds an international dimension that helps expand its footprint in global markets

► The iconic Swift hatchback is introduced, which begins the premium hatchback revolution in India. The same year, Maruti rolls out its five-millionth car



Minister. At that time, there were a lot of industrial activities happening in the state. When we started looking around for expansion, Gujarat had two major factors in its favour. One, the state administration appeared to be by far the most industry-friendly administration anywhere in the country. That's why people were coming to Gujarat and things were happening quickly. The second was, of course, the fact that the state was close to the port where we were exporting from. And that would save a lot of money.

What has come out in these 40 years is that the people of this country are looking to get a good, convenient means of commuting. It's not like we did something extraordinary. We wouldn't have succeeded if the consumers of this country had not wanted this to happen. Companies succeed because the customer wants that company to succeed. We've learnt this lesson that if you continue to do what is expected or desired

by the masses, you cannot but succeed. I'm reminded of my time as a bureaucrat who decided what everybody else should have. We thought we were very smart but we weren't. Consumers were the last on our minds. One big learning has been to listen to the people.

Till a few years ago, I had become quite pessimistic about many kinds of industrial growth in India because various things used to be said, but nothing would happen on the ground. I was part of a committee, which was set up by the Planning Commission to increase

industrial competitiveness. We had a lot of meetings and discussions but nothing happened. But this government says that manufacturing growth is the key to India's progress and that started the whole programme of ease of doing business in India. The government is working on identifying the pain points in doing business and removing those. It had never happened in the past. They recognise that the private sector will be at the forefront of economic growth. That profit is not a dirty word anymore. That makes you realise India is

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